

NEW CONTOURS



◀ REWIND

REGIONAL KING:
Y.B. Chavan (left) taking
oath as the first chief
minister of Maharashtra

India was being re-ordered on linguistic lines. Resentment in western India—which wasn't covered by the States Reorganisation Commission in 1956—was finally assuaged when the states of Maharashtra and Gujarat were formed. In the north, Master Tara Singh and Fateh Singh fasted "unto death" while their Akali Dal supporters courted arrests, demanding a state for Punjabis. After years of agitation by rebel leader A.Z. Phizo, who charged the Indian Army with genocide, Jawaharlal Nehru announced that a state of Nagaland would be carved out of Assam.

AN ACCIDENT

The Indian Air Force's first Indian Chief of Air Staff, Air Marshal Subroto Mukherjee, choked to death while having a meal with friends in Tokyo, Japan. He had flown there aboard Air India's first flight to Tokyo. He was also the first Indian to command a flight and a squadron in the Indian Air Force.

FIRST CUT

- Air India went international with its maiden flight from Delhi to New York.
- The first Hindi Encyclopaedia released by Nagari Pracharini Sabha came out on October 16.

REBEL FACE Angami Zapu Phizo

The firebrand leader of the Naga National Council went to Switzerland on a forged Ei Salvadorean passport. David Astor, the owner of the *Observer* newspaper, made Angami Zapu Phizo a hero, supporting a series of press conferences where he painted the Indian government as anti-Christian and charged the Indian Army with genocide while demanding an independent Nagaland. Phizo had declared Nagaland independent way back in 1947, a day before India became independent. Nehru declared Nagaland a separate state in 1960, but the insurgency and demands for independence continued, with the "father of the Nagas" remaining a rebel till his death in 1992.

